

Bless This House / Bless This Union

**Edited
in
Closed score staff and Tonic Sol-fa
by
Nwosu Raphael**

In Memoriam: Sept. 11, 2001

SATB Version

First Performance; sept. 12, 2002
Los Angeles Philharmonic at
the Hollywood Bowl
Susan Graham, soprano soloist

Bless This Union:

A Contra-factum of "Bless This House"
Done by **Chijioke Ngobili** to be used
at marriage functions/services)

Taylor - Brahe
arr. Randol Alan Bass

[Doh is F] **Andante con tenerezza**

Piano

The piano introduction is in 4/4 time, starting with a mezzo-piano (mp) dynamic. It features a melody in the right hand and a supporting bass line in the left hand. The tempo is marked 'Andante con tenerezza'. The piece concludes with a 'poco rit.' (poco ritardando) marking and a triplet of eighth notes in the right hand.

A tempo

[Unison Chorus]

5 *mp*

d : m | s :- . s | l :- . l | s :- | f : s | m : d | r : t | d :-

Bless this house, O Lord we pray, make it safe by night and day;
Bless this U - nion, Lord we pray, Se - cure it by night and day;

The first system of the Unison Chorus begins at measure 5. It features a melody in the right hand and a supporting bass line in the left hand. The tempo is marked 'A tempo' and the dynamic is mezzo-piano (mp). The lyrics are: 'Bless this house, O Lord we pray, make it safe by night and day; Bless this U - nion, Lord we pray, Se - cure it by night and day;'.

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d : m | s :- . s | l :- . l | s :- | f : s | m : d | r : t | d :-

Bless these walls, so firm and stout, Keep - ing want and trou - ble out;
Bless the man with strength and grace, Keep him wise to lead their path;

The second system of the Unison Chorus begins at measure 9. It features a melody in the right hand and a supporting bass line in the left hand. The tempo is marked 'A tempo' and the dynamic is mezzo-piano (mp). The lyrics are: 'Bless these walls, so firm and stout, Keep - ing want and trou - ble out; Bless the man with strength and grace, Keep him wise to lead their path;'.

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Bless the roof and chim-ney tall, Let thy peace lie o-ver all; Bless the door, that
Bless the wife with love and luck, May she be their light in dark; Bless their Home that

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it may prove e-ver o-pen to joy—and love.
it may prove, e-ver o-pen to joy—and love.

mp cresc.

poco rit. D.1 *mp*

22 | : | : | : | : | [l]d : m | s : s | l : l | s :- | f : s | m : d

[l]d : m | s : s | f : f | m :- | r . d : t | s . t : l |
 Bless these win - dows shin - ing bright, Let - ting in God's
 Bless these peo - ple here who've come, Let them re - diate

[l]d' :- | - :- | d' :- | r' : d' | l : s | t . s : f

[t]r : r | d : d

mf *poco rit.* *p*

27 | r : t | d :- | d : m | s :- s | l : l | t :- t | d' :- d' | r' : t | l : l | s :-

l : r . s | t : l | s : d | t : r | d : r . f | m :- m | m : ma | r :- s | s : fe | r :-
 heav'n - ly light; Bless the hearth a - blaz - ing there, with smoke as - cend - ing like a pray'r;
 forth your light; Bless our hearts as we sit here, with good de - sires — we so seek;

f : s | s : f | m : s | s : t | l : d' . l | l : se | . fe : s . l | t . d' : r' | d' : t : d' . r' | d' . l : t

ta : s | d :- | d : d | m :- m | f : f | m : m | l : - . l | s : s | r : r | s :- . f

p *mf*

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d' :- d' | t : s
s :- s | s : s | l : l | s :- | l :- l | s : m | r : d | r :- | d : r | m : d

m :- m | m : m | s . f : d . r | m :- | f . m : r . l | d . r : d . s | ta : d | t : :- | d : t | ta : ta
Bless the folks who dwell with - in, keep them pure and free from sin; Bless us all that
Bless all peo - ple of good - will, keep them pure and free from sin; Bless this man who's

d' :- d' | t : t | d' : l | ta :- | l : f | s :- m | f : f | s :- | m :- f | s : m

m :- m | s : m | f : f | de :- | r :- r | m : d | r : r | r :- | d : d | d :- d
l : l | m : m | ta : la | s : :-

mp *p cresc.*

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f : s | l :- | r : m | fe : r | s : l | t :- | m' :- m' | r' : t

d : m | f . m : r . de | l : de | d : d | d :- r | r . s : s . f | m :- m | r : m
we may be fit, O Lord, to dwell with Thee, Bless us all that
found his wife, Bless the wife who's found her man, Bless their u - nion

l : d' | l :- s | fe :- s | l : fe | r . s : l . fe | t :- | d' :- d' | d' : m' . r'
f : | l . fe : se

f :- f | f . s : f . m | r : r | r :- r | r : r | r : r | r : r | m :- s | m :- m
s : s | s : s | s : s | d :- d | m :- m

f

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A tempo

mp dolce

one day we may dwell, O Lord, with Thee.
 Lord we pray and dwell, al- ways with them.

mp

p

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